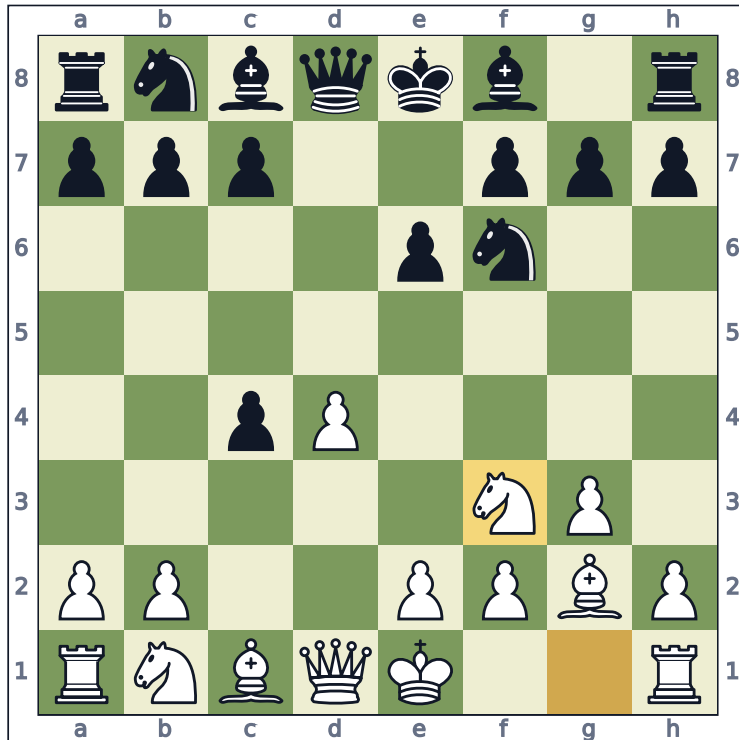


CATALAN OPENING

Catalan Opening

ECO E04 | 3 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.31 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

E04 covers Catalan Opening. White combines d4 and c4 with a g2 bishop, seeking long-term pressure and excellent piece activity. The diagram uses the featured line Catalan Opening: Open Defense.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. g3 d5 4. Bg2 dxc4 5. Nf3

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the long diagonal, recover a sacrificed c-pawn without losing coordination, and press queenside weaknesses patiently.

BLACK'S GOALS

Choose whether to hold c4, return it for development, or close the diagonal; seek ...c5 or ...e5 for freedom.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 challenge the center; White often uses Ne5, Qc2, and a4 to recover or undermine c4.

PIECE MAP

The g2 bishop is the soul of White's position. Black must manage the a8-h1 diagonal and queenside development. White's g2 bishop makes the long diagonal a strategic asset. the material imbalance means development and compensation must be calculated, not assumed.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

White should not rush to regain a pawn if doing so loses the initiative; Black should not cling to it at any cost. Do not judge the gambit only by the pawn count; compare king safety, tempi, and open lines.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Black is ahead by about 1 pawn unit. Central markers: Black pawn on c4, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A top-class strategic opening, especially strong for players who enjoy durable pressure rather than forced attacks.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named E04 line

This section preserves all 3 names and defining routes assigned to E04 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 **Catalan Opening: Open Defense**
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. g3 d5 4. Bg2 dxc4 5. Nf3

002 **Catalan Opening: Open Defense**
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 c6 5. Bg2 dxc4

003 **Catalan Opening: Open Defense, Modern Sharp Variation**
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. g3 d5 4. Bg2 dxc4 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. Qa4 Bb4+